

LEGAL CASE FILE: State vs. Arjun Mehta

● Case Title

State of West Bengal vs. Arjun Mehta

● Court

Hon'ble City Civil Court, Kolkata

● Date of Filing

12 March 2025

● Parties Involved

Plaintiff: State of West Bengal

Defendant: Arjun Mehta (Software Engineer)

● Background of the Case

Arjun Mehta, a software engineer working at a private fintech company, was accused of unauthorized access to internal banking records. The allegation states that he allegedly accessed customer transaction logs without permission and exported sensitive financial data.

The company reported unusual API activity between 02:00 AM and 03:00 AM on 5 January 2025. Internal audit logs suggested that the access originated from Arjun Mehta's employee credentials.

However, the defense argues that the system was compromised due to a **misconfigured API gateway**, and the access was not intentionally performed by the defendant.

● Evidence Presented

● Evidence 1: Server Logs

- Multiple API requests were made using Arjun Mehta's credentials
- Requests targeted /internal/transactions/export
- Timestamp: 02:14 AM – 02:47 AM

● Evidence 2: IP Address Report

- IP Address: 103.48.92.11
- Location: Kolkata, India

- Matches employee office network range
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● Evidence 3: IT Audit Report

- Indicates possible misconfiguration in authentication middleware
 - Token validation bypass vulnerability detected
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● Evidence 4: Company Policy Document

- Strict prohibition on accessing financial records without approval
 - Violation leads to termination and legal action
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● Defense Statement

The defense claims:

- No intentional data theft occurred
 - Credentials may have been used due to system vulnerability
 - Arjun Mehta was not logged into the system at the reported time
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● Prosecution Argument

The prosecution argues:

- Credentials were used directly
 - Sensitive data export occurred
 - Company policy was violated
 - Access originated from defendant's system
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● Charges Filed

- Unauthorized access to protected systems (IT Act Section 43)
 - Attempted data exfiltration
 - Breach of confidentiality agreement
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● Current Status

Case is under trial and awaiting final judgment.